

Inheritance

1

```
#include
#include <namespace std>
class Pet
{
public:
// Constructors, Destructors
Pet(): weight(1), food("Pet Chow") {}
~Pet() {}

//Accessors
void setWeight(int w) {weight = w;}
int getWeight() {return weight;}
void setFood(string f) {food = f;}
string getFood() {return food;}

//General methods
void eat();
void speak();

protected:
int weight;
string food;
};

void Pet::eat()
{
cout << "Eating " << food << endl;
}

void Pet::speak()
{
cout << "Growl" << endl;
}

class Rat: public Pet
{
public:
Rat() {}
~Rat() {}

//Other methods
void sicken() {cout << "Spreading Plague" << endl;}
};

class Cat: public Pet
{
public:
Cat(): numberToes(5) {}
~Cat() {}

//Other accessors
void setNumberToes(int toes) {numberToes = toes;}
int getNumberToes() {return numberToes;}

private:
int numberToes;
};

int main()
{
Rat charles;
Cat fluffy;

charles.setWeight(25);
cout << "Charles weighs " << charles.getWeight() << "
lbs." << endl;
charles.speak();
charles.eat();
charles.sicken();

fluffy.speak();
fluffy.eat();
cout << "Fluffy has " << fluffy.getNumberToes() << "
toes" << endl;

return 0;
}
```

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Output

```
C:\> "c:\Documents and Settings..."
Charles weighs 25 lbs.
Growl
Eating Pet Chow
Spreading Plague
Growl
Eating Pet Chow
Fluffy has 5toes
Press any key to continue
```

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comments

- notice that the data members of the Pet base class are declared as **protected**. Protected indicates that publicly derived subtypes of the base class will be able to directly access these variables.
- If they were declared to be **private**, only the Pet class could directly access them; subclasses could not.
- If they were declared **public**, any class or part of code could accessed them. This would defeat a key goal of object-oriented design: **encapsulating** data within a class and exposing the data only through the public interface.

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comments

- The last thing to notice in this example is that **constructors**, including **copy constructors**, and **destructors** are not inherited. Each subtype has its own constructor and destructor.

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comments

- Rat and Cat objects inherit the methods of the base class, Pet. We can call the **speak** method and the **eat** method on objects of type Rat and Cat. These methods were defined only in Pet and not in the subclasses.
- Also, notice the each subclass extends the base class by adding methods and members. The Rat class has the **"sicken"** method. The Cat class has methods and members related to the number of toes an individual cat object has.
- This is the most common software reuse by **extending additional behaviors** in OO system development

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basic principle of inheritance

- The base class contains common members and methods used by the subclasses
- The subtypes are more specialized than the base class.

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```
#include
using namespace std;

class Pet
{
public:
    // Constructors, Destructors
    Pet(): weight(1), food("Pet Chow")
    {
        cout << "Pet Constructor" << endl;
    }
    ~Pet()
    {
        cout << "Pet Destructor" << endl;
    }

    // Rest of code unmodified from first example
    ....
};

class Rat: public Pet
{
public:
    Rat()
    {
        cout << "Rat Constructor" << endl;
    }
    ~Rat()
    {
        cout << "Rat Destructor" << endl;
    }

    // Rest of code unmodified from first example
    ....
};

class Cat: public Pet
{
public:
    Cat(): numberToes(5)
    {
        cout << "Cat Constructor" << endl;
    }
    ~Cat()
    {
        cout << "Cat Destructor" << endl;
    }

    // Rest of code unmodified from first example
    ....
};

int main()
{
    Rat charles;
    Cat fluffy;

    //charles.setWeight(25); //cout << "Charles weighs " <<
    //charles.getWeight() << " lbs." << endl;
    //charles.speak();
    //charles.eat();
    //charles.sicken();

    //fluffy.speak();
    //fluffy.eat();
    //cout << "Fluffy has " <<
    //fluffy.getNumberToes() << "toes" << endl;

    return 0;
}
```

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output

```
Pet Constructor
Rat Constructor
Pet Constructor
Cat Constructor
Cat Destructor
Pet Destructor
Rat Destructor
Pet Destructor
Press any key to continue
```

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comments

- The **base class** part of an object is always constructed first and destroyed last. The **subclass** part of an object is constructed last and destroyed first.
- The reason for this is that each object of a subtype consists of multiple parts, a base class part and a subclass part. The base class constructor forms the base class part. The subclass constructor forms the subclass part. Destructors clean up their respective parts.
- 每一個 subclass 要自行負責建構與清除自己的特異化的部分

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Passing arguments into constructors

- In the previous example, all the classes used **default constructors**. That is, the constructors took no arguments. Suppose that there were constructors that took arguments. How would this be handled? Here's a simple example.

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```
#include <iostream>
#include <string>
using namespace std;

class Pet
{
public:
    // Constructors, Destructors
    Pet(): weight(1), food("Pet Chow")
    {}
    Pet(int w): weight(w), food("Pet Chow") {}
    Pet(int w, string f): weight(w), food(f) {}
    ~Pet() {}

    //Accessors
    void setWeight(int w) {weight = w;}
    int getWeight() {return weight;}

    void setFood(string f) {food = f;}
    string getFood() {return food;}

    //General methods
    void eat();
    void speak();

protected:
    int weight;
    string food;
};

void Pet::eat()
{
    cout << "Eating " << food << endl;
}

void Pet::speak()
{
    cout << "Growl" << endl;
}

class Rat: public Pet
{
public:
    Rat() {}
    Rat(int w): Pet(w) {}
    Rat(int w, string f): Pet(w, f) {}
    ~Rat() {}

    //Other methods
    void sicken() {cout << "Spreading Plague" << endl;}
};

class Cat: public Pet
{
public:
    Cat(): numberToes(5) {}
    Cat(int w): Pet(w), numberToes(5) {}
    Cat(int w, string f): Pet(w, f), numberToes(5) {}
    Cat(int w, string f, int toes): Pet(w, f), numberToes(toes) {}
    ~Cat() {}

    //Other accessors
    void setNumberToes(int toes) {numberToes = toes;}
    int getNumberToes() {return numberToes;}

private:
    int numberToes;
};

int main()
{
    Rat charles(25, "Rat Chow");
    Rat john; //Default Rat constructor
    Cat fluffy(10, "rats");
    Cat buffy(10, "fish", 6);

    cout << "Charles weighs " << charles.getWeight() << " lbs." << endl;
    charles.speak();
    charles.eat();
    charles.sicken();

    cout << "John weighs " << john.getWeight() << " lbs." << endl;
    john.speak();
    john.eat();
    john.sicken();

    fluffy.speak();
    fluffy.eat();
    cout << "Fluffy has " << fluffy.getNumberToes() << "toes" << endl;
    buffy.speak();
    buffy.eat();
    cout << "Buffy has " << buffy.getNumberToes() << "toes" << endl;

    return 0;
}
```

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comments

- Rat and Cat constructors that take arguments, which are in turn passed to the appropriate Pet constructor. The base class, Pet, constructor is added to the [member initialization list](#) of the derived class constructors.
- Also notice that for the derived class (Rat and Cat) default constructors, the Pet default constructor does not need to be explicitly called.

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A complete list of invoked constructors

```

• Rat charles(25,"Rat Chow");
  Pet(int w, string f)
  Rat(int w, string f)

  Rat john;
  Pet()
  Rat()

  Cat fluffy(10,"rats");
  Pet(int w, string f)
  Cat(int w, string f)

  Cat buffy(10,"fish",6);
  Pet(int w, string f)
  Cat(int w, string f, int toes)

```

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Output

```

Charles weighs 25 lbs.
Growl
Eating Rat Chow
Spreading Plague
John weighs 1 lbs.
Growl
Eating Pet Chow
Spreading Plague
Growl
Eating rats
Fluffy has 5 toes
Growl
Eating fish
Buffy has 6 toes
Press any key to continue

```

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Overriding methods

- A [derived class](#) can use the methods of its [base class](#)(es), or it can [override](#) them.
- The method in the derived class must have the same [signature](#) and return type as the base class method to override.
 - The signature is number and type of arguments and the constantness (const, non-const) of the method. When an object of the base class is used, the base class method is called.
- Note that overriding is different from [overloading](#). With overloading, many methods of the same name with different signatures (different number and/or types of arguments) are created.
- With overriding, a subclass implements its own version of a base class method. The subclass can selectively use some base class methods as they are, and override others.

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```

#include <iostream>
#include <string>
using namespace std;

class Pet
{
public:
    // Constructors, Destructors
    Pet() : weight(1), food("Pet Chow") {}
    Pet(int w : weight(w), food("Pet Chow") {}
    Pet(int w, string f) : weight(w), food(f) {}
    ~Pet() {}
    //Accessors
    void setWeight(int w) {weight = w;}
    int getWeight() {return weight;}

    void setFood(string f) {food = f;}
    string getFood() {return food;}

    //General methods
    void eat();
    void speak();

protected:
    int weight;
    string food;
};

void Pet::eat() {
    cout << "Eating " << food << endl;
}

void Pet::speak() {
    cout << "Growl" << endl;
}

class Rat : public Pet
{
public:
    Rat() {}
    Rat(int w) : Pet(w) {}
    Rat(int w, string f) : Pet(w,f) {}
    ~Rat() {}
    //Other methods
    void sicken() {cout << "Spreading Plague" << endl;}
    void speak() {}
    void Rat::speak() {cout << "Rat noise" << endl;}
};

class Cat : public Pet
{
public:
    Cat() : numberToes(5) {}
    Cat(int w) : Pet(w, numberToes(5)) {}
    Cat(int w, string f) : Pet(w,f, numberToes(5)) {}
    Cat(int w, string f, int toes) : Pet(w,f,
        numberToes(toes)) {}
    ~Cat() {}
    //Other accessors
    void setNumberToes(int toes) {numberToes = toes;}
    int getNumberToes() {return numberToes;}

    //Other methods
    void speak();

private:
    int numberToes;
};

void Cat::speak() { cout << "Meow" << endl; }

int main()
{
    Pet peter;
    Rat ralph;
    Cat chris;

    peter.speak();
    ralph.speak();
    chris.speak();

    return 0;
}

```

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output

```

Growl
Rat noise
Meow
Press any key to continue

```

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Notice

- remember that the **return type** and signature of the subclass method must match the base class method exactly to override.
- Another important point is that if the base class had overloaded a particular method, overriding a single one of the overloads will hide the rest.
 - For instance, suppose the Pet class had defined several speak methods.

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Be very careful!

- ```
void speak();
void speak(string s);
void speak(string s, int loudness);
```

If the subclass, Cat, defined only **void speak();**

Then **speak()** would be overridden. **speak(string s)** and **speak(string s, int loudness)** would be hidden. This means that if we had a cat object, fluffy, we could call:

```
fluffy.speak();
```

But the following would cause compilation errors.

```
fluffy.speak("Hello");
fluffy.speak("Hello", 10);
```
- Generally, if you override an **overloaded base class** method you should either override every one of the overloads, or carefully consider why you are not. It is a safety protocol enforced by compiler to prevent you from doing such error

These are overloaded methods

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## The Principle of Inheritance

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```
class EmployeeCensus: public ListContainer {
public:
 ...
 // public routines
 void AddEmployee(Employee employee);
 void RemoveEmployee(Employee employee);

 Employee NextItemInList();
 Employee FirstItem();
 Employee LastItem();
 ...
private:
 ...
};
```

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- This class is representing two ADTs: an employee and a ListContainer.

C++ Example of a Class Interface with Consistent Levels of Abstraction

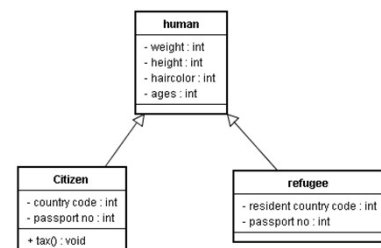
```
class EmployeeCensus {
public:
 ...
 // public routines
 void AddEmployee(Employee employee);
 void RemoveEmployee(Employee employee);
 Employee NextEmployee();
 Employee FirstEmployee();
 Employee LastEmployee();
 ...
private:
 ListContainer m_EmployeeList;
 ...
};
```

The abstraction of all these routines is now at the "employee" level.

That the class uses the ListContainer library is now hidden.

## To subclass or not to subclass?

- Consider you are a UN (United Nation ) staff

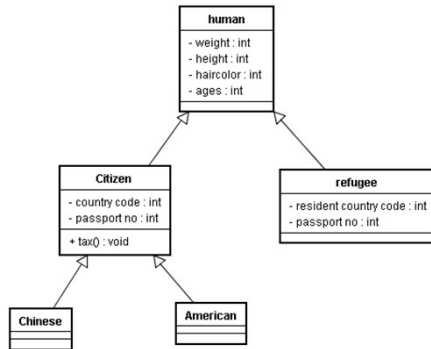


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## Do you want to keep going?



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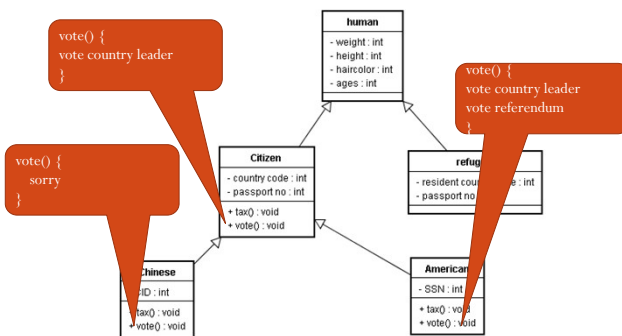
## The answer

- No
  - The country code is already capable of distinguishing citizenships of country
- This subclassing is meaningless until

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## Until object's behaviors must be specialized and distinguished



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## Thumb Rule

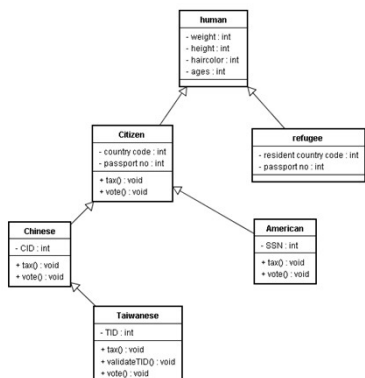
- A citizen is a human?
- An American is a citizen?
  - => An american is a human?
  - Inheritance relation is transitive
- A Chinese is a citizen?
- A citizen is a human?
- A Chinese is a human?

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## To subclass or not to subclass?

The UN staff wants to follow one-China policy



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- Taiwanese all inherit CID
- Taiwanese overrides the tax() and vote() method
- Taiwanese has a specialized attributes called TID
- Taiwanese has a new method to validate if a TID is valid.

## By so inheriting, the UN staff means

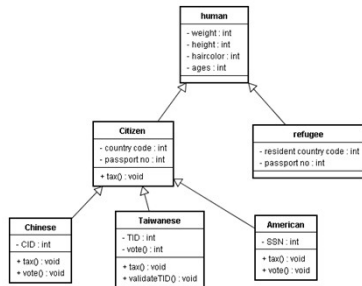
- Taiwanese is a Chinese, is a citizen, and is a human
- Chinese is not necessary a Taiwanese
- Taiwanese has an attribute called CID, but is never used (this is something wrong)

- OK..This is very heavy

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## How about this inheritance?



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## By this inheritance, you mean

- Taiwanese is not a Chinese
- But Taiwanese and Chinese are both citizens and human.
- Taiwanese does not inherit CID attributes

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## More exercise of overriding

```

#include <iostream>
using namespace std;
class pet {
public:
 pet() { cout << "pet constructor" << endl; }
 ~pet() { cout << "pet destructor" << endl; }
 void speak() { cout << "Growl" << endl; }
};

class cat: public pet {
public:
 cat() { cout << "cat constructor" << endl; }
 ~cat() { cout << "cat destructor" << endl; }
 void speak() { cout << "meow" << endl; }
};

main() {
 pet insect;
 cat pussy;
 pet * nose = (pet *) new
 cat();

 insect.speak();
 pussy.speak();
 ((pet) pussy).speak();
 nose-> speak();
}

```

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## Output

```

Screen Tox v3.10 - UNREGISTERED
[typer@omniwars ~]$./a
pet constructor
pet constructor
cat constructor
pet constructor
cat constructor
Growl
meow
Growl
pet destructor
Growl
cat destructor
pet destructor
pet destructor

```

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## Confused?

- When you use a subclass to override a base class' s method, C++ will use the current type to determine the method
- This is not the polymorphism you expect.
- 當你用一個 subclass override 掉 base class 的 method 時, C++ 會根據目前物件的 type 來幫你呼叫 methods
- 在運用多型的時候, 你會不想要讓這樣的事情發生, 要怎麼辦?

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